

YOUR STEM HERO



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2025 Fascinate Media Inc.

YOUR STEM HERO

Overview:

Your STEM Hero is an interactive, career-focused workshop that prepares students for future STEM pathways through creative storytelling and research. Students will work in groups to create a fictional STEM professional's life journey from childhood to career success, research authentic career pathways, and present their "STEM Hero" in a Wikipedia-style format at a Career and College Fair.

Order of Operations:

1. Organize into groups of 5-6 and Assign Roles

Students will be organized into groups of 5-6 and assign specific growth area responsibilities:

- Writer/Researcher/Presenter - Origin Story (birth-middle school): Develop the avatar's early life narrative and formative experiences
- Writer/Researcher/Presenter - High School: Focus on activities, achievements, and interests related to their chosen profession
- Writer/Researcher/Presenter - College Career: Research appropriate college pathways, majors, internships, and activities
- Writer/Researcher/Presenter - Professional Career: Map career progression, achievements, and professional development
- Illustrator/Presenter - Motivation: Create visual representations of the avatar at each life stage and develop logos for relevant organizations

Note: The avatar is not meant to be completely new, but rather a composite character representing elements from all group members these aspects of the project.



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2. Create an Avatar with Origin Story

Student groups will:

- Use AI tools like ChatGPT or Midjourney to create visual representations of their avatar
- Develop avatars for each life stage of the career progression
- Establish demographic details including gender, ethnicity, birthplace, and family background
- Identify sources of motivation, challenges faced, and how challenges were overcome

3. Select a STEM Profession

Student groups will choose from established STEM career tracks:

Science

- Chemist
- Physicist
- Astrophysicist
- Environmental Scientist
- Pharmacist
- Medical Doctor
- Cancer Researcher
- Data Scientist

Technology

- UX Designer
- Graphic Designer
- CTO - Chief Technology Officer
- CEO of Tech Company
- Salesforce Technician
- AI Developer
- Full Stack Developer
- Cyber Security Specialist

Engineering

- Audio Engineer
- Civil Engineer
- Electrical Engineer
- Software Engineer
- Biomedical Engineer
- Agricultural Engineer
- Aerospace Engineer

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4. Research STEM Profession

Student groups will conduct thorough research to:

- Create detailed descriptions of their avatar's profession
- Learn required academic pathways (SAT scores, GPA, recommended majors, internships, extracurricular experiences)
- Map post-graduation career progression (entry-level positions, timeline, advancement opportunities)
- Identify authentic challenges and success strategies in the chosen field
- Fact-check all educational institutions and programs to ensure they actually exist and that the academic pathway is realistic and coherent
- Verify that the professional trajectory aligns with real-world career progression in the field

5. Draft Wikipedia Page

Student groups will develop a professional Wikipedia-style profile that includes:

- Early Childhood: Formative experiences and early interests in STEM
- High School: Academic performance, extracurricular activities, and emerging career interests
- College Career: Major selection, internships, research projects, and professional development
- Professional Career: Career trajectory, notable achievements, and contributions to the field

For the drafting process:

- Use an AI platform like ChatGPT to help generate initial ideas for the origin story
- Ensure the overall narrative connects logically across all life stages
- Include appropriate citations and references as would appear in a real Wikipedia entry

Extra Challenge: After generating content with AI assistance, students should rewrite the biography in their own words, adding personal touches and creative elements that reflect their understanding of the career path.

Example wiki page for reference: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Aisha_Bowe



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6. Practice Presentation

Student groups will:

- Finalize their Wikipedia page with complete content and visuals
- Receive public speaking guidance and feedback
- Conduct multiple practice runs to ensure cohesive storytelling
- Prepare for audience questions and engagement

7. Presentation Judging

Student presentations will be formally evaluated by a panel of judges (teachers, industry professionals, or older students) based on the following criteria:

- Knowledge of Content (1-10): Depth of understanding about the STEM career pathway, accuracy of information, and research quality
- Narrative Coherence (1-10): How well the life stages connect logically and realistically to form a complete career journey
- Presentation Quality (1-10): Professional delivery, speaking skills, visual aids, and overall engagement
- Creativity (1-10): Originality of the avatar concept, innovative solutions to challenges, and unique presentation elements
- Question Response (1-10): Ability to thoughtfully and accurately respond to judges' questions about the career pathway



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Sample Discussion Questions for Teachers:

Early Planning Discussions:

- How did you decide on this particular STEM career? What aspects of it interest your group the most?
- What early experiences or influences might lead someone toward this career path?
- What obstacles or challenges might your avatar face on this career journey?
- How will you ensure your avatar's story is both realistic and inspirational?

Research Process Discussions:

- What surprised you most about the educational requirements for this career?
- How has this career field changed in the past decade? How might it change in the future?
- What specific skills or qualities are most important for success in this field?
- How do the different stages of your avatar's life connect to create a coherent pathway to their career?

AI Usage Discussions:

- How did you prompt the AI tool to get useful results? What strategies worked best?
- What aspects of AI-generated content did you need to fact-check or modify?
- How did you balance using AI as a helpful tool versus doing your own research and thinking?
- What are the advantages and limitations of using AI for this kind of project?

Presentation Preparation Discussions:

- How are you dividing speaking responsibilities among team members?
- What visual elements will help your audience understand your avatar's journey?
- What questions do you anticipate from your audience, and how will you address them?
- How does your presentation highlight the most important aspects of this STEM career?

Reflection Discussions:

- What aspects of your avatar's journey could you personally relate to?
- Did researching this career path change any of your perceptions about it?
- What did you learn about teamwork and collaboration during this project?
- How might this experience influence your own thinking about future career options?